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BAGONG PILIPINAS

CC 101 – Introduction to Computing

Laboratory Worksheet No. 1 | Week 3: Computer Components I – Hardware (CO2)

"Know Your Machine": Exploring the Computer Unit You Are Using

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Computer Unit Used (Desktop/Laptop, brand):	**Date:** September 16, 2026

I. Objectives

At the end of this activity, you should be able to:

- Identify the major hardware components of the computer unit you are using and describe the function of each.
- Use built-in Windows 11 tools to inspect and record your computer's technical specifications.
- Distinguish between input, output, processing, and storage devices on an actual working computer.
- Document your exploration accurately and reflect on what you learned.

II. Materials Needed

- A computer unit running Windows 11 (school laboratory PC or personal laptop/desktop)
- This worksheet (printed copy, or the digital file to fill out and submit)
- Optional: smartphone camera, to photograph the physical unit and ports for your own reference

III. Background

Every computer, whether a desktop tower or a laptop, is built from hardware components that fall into four general categories: input devices (send data into the computer, e.g., keyboard, mouse), output devices (present processed data to the user, e.g., monitor, speakers), the processing/storage unit (CPU, RAM, and drives that compute and hold data), and ports/peripherals (connectors that link external devices to the system unit). Windows 11 also provides several built-in tools — Settings, System Information, Device Manager, and Task Manager — that let you inspect these components without opening the case. This activity uses both direct observation and these software tools.

IV. Procedure

Part A – Physical Inspection (5–10 minutes)

1. Examine the computer unit in front of you. If it is a desktop, look at the system unit (tower/case); if it is a laptop, examine the whole chassis.
2. List all the input devices you can see or that are built in (e.g., keyboard, mouse, touchpad, webcam, microphone).
3. List all the output devices you can see or that are built in (e.g., monitor/screen, speakers, headphone jack).
4. Locate the available ports on the unit (USB-A, USB-C, HDMI, audio jack, Ethernet/LAN, power, etc.) and note what each one is typically used to connect.

Part B – System Identification (Settings)

5. Click Start → Settings → System → About.

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6. Record the Device name, Processor, Installed RAM, Device ID, and System type shown under Device specifications.
7. Scroll down to Windows specifications and record the Edition, Version, and OS build.

Part C – Detailed Hardware Check (System Information)

8. Press the Windows key, type System Information, and open it (this runs the msinfo32 tool).
9. On the System Summary page, record the System Manufacturer, System Model, BIOS Version/Date, and Total Physical Memory.

Part D – Device Manager Exploration

10. Right-click the Start button and choose Device Manager.
11. Expand at least six (6) categories — for example: Display adapters, Network adapters, Sound/video/game controllers, Disk drives, Keyboards, Mice and other pointing devices, and Universal Serial Bus controllers.
12. For each category you expand, write down the specific device name Windows lists (this is the exact model of that component in your unit).

Part E – Performance and Storage Check (Task Manager)

13. Open Task Manager (Ctrl + Shift + Esc) and click the Performance tab.
14. Record the CPU name, base speed, and number of cores; the total Memory (RAM) and its speed; and the Disk type (HDD or SSD) and capacity.

Part F – Software Snapshot (Optional / Bonus)

15. Go to Settings → Apps → Installed apps. List five (5) installed applications and classify each as System Software or Application Software.

V. Data and Findings

Table 1. System Identification Summary (Parts B & C)

Item	Your Findings
Device name	Aspire AL14-42P
Processor	AMD Ryzen 3 5300U with Radeon Graphic (2.60 GHz)
Installed RAM	8.00GB (7.36 GB usable)
Device ID	C6C3C925-A571-4F26-9C88-FF96B62C0C0E
System type (32-bit / 64-bit)	64-bit operating system, x64-based processor
Windows edition	Windows Feature Experience Pack 1000.26100.360.0
Windows version	25H2
OS build	26200.9445
System manufacturer	Acer

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Item	Your Findings
System model	Aspire AL14-42P
BIOS version / date	American Magpatrends international, LLC. V1. 04,10/17/2025
Total physical memory	8.00GB

Table 2. Physical Components Observed (Part A)

Component Observed	Type (Input/Output/Storage/Processing/Port)	Description / Observation
Built in Keyboard	Input	A slim island style keys below the screen. It contains all letters, numbers, function keys; used to type and send command intothe laptop.
Touchpad	Input	Smooth rectangular surface under the keyboard with left/right click area. I see the cursor move when I glide my finger over it.
Webcam	Input	Small round lens at the top center of the screen bezel. A tiny LED beside it lights up when active; captures video and photos.
Build-in Microsoft	Input	Two tiny pinholes near the webcam. I see them beside the camera; picks up my voice and surrounding sound.
Display/Screen	Output	14-inch glossy panel showing icons, text, and images. Brightness changes when I adjust keys; shows everything the laptop produces.
Build-in Speaker	Output	Slotted grilles on the bottom edge. I hear sound come from here when playing music or videos; no external speaker needed.
USB-A PORT	Port	Standard rectangular slot on the left side. I plug in my flash drive and mouse here; fits older USB cables.
USB-C PORT	Port	Small oval slot on the right side. I use it to charge the laptop; newer shape for faster data and power.

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Component Observed	Type (Input/Output/Storage/Processing/Port)	Description / Observation
HDMI Port	Port	Flat wide slot next to the USB ports. Labeled "HDMI"; used to connect to a TV or external monitor.
3.5mm Audio Jack	Port	Small round hole on the left side. Headphones fit inside; sound plays through them instead of the built-in speakers.

Table 3. Device Manager Findings (Part D)

Device Manager Category	Specific Device Name Listed
Display adapters	AMD Radeon (TM) Graphics
Network adapters	Bluetooth Device (Personal Area Network) Realtek 8852BE Wireless LAN Wi-Fi 6 PCI-E NIC, WAN Miniport
Sound, video and game controllers	AMD High Definition Audio Device, BISEN-BT 176, BISEN-BT176 Hands-Free, Realtek(R) Audio
Disk drives	TWAC TSC3AN512-F1T40S
Keyboards	Standard PS/2 Keyboard
Mice and other pointing devices	HID-complaint mouse
Universal Serial Bus controllers	AMD USB 3.10 eXtensible Host Controller – 1.10 (Microsoft) Generic SuperSpeed USB Hub Generic USB Hub Realtek USB 2.0 Card Reader USB Composite Device USB Root Hub (USB 3.0)

Table 4. Software Snapshot (Part F, Optional / Bonus)

Installed Application	Classification (System / Application Software)
iCloud Outlook	Application Software
McAfee	Application Software

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Installed Application	Classification (System / Application Software)
Facebook	Application Software
Acer Jumpstart	System Software
Visual Studio Code	Application Software
Photopea	Application Software
AMD Software	System Software
Microsoft OneDrive	System Software

VI. Realization (Reflection)

In two to four sentences each, answer the following in your own words.

1. What did you discover about your own computer unit that you did not know before doing this activity?

I found out my laptop uses an AMD Ryzen 3 5300U processor with 8.00 GB of RAM, and I learned its exact device name and system details I had never checked before. I also realized which programs are built-in system tools and which ones I installed myself, like Visual Studio Code and Photopea.

2. Which hardware component do you think matters most to how your computer performs, and why?

I believe the processor matters most because it acts as the brain of the computer. It handles almost every task and calculation, so a good processor means the laptop runs faster, opens programs smoothly, and can handle more work at once without slowing down.

3. How might knowing your computer's hardware and software specifications help you as a future IT/CS professional?

Knowing these specifications will help me choose compatible software, troubleshoot technical issues, and recommend suitable upgrades for different devices. It also builds the essential knowledge I need to understand how computer systems work as I pursue my future career in IT and computer science.

4. What difficulties, if any, did you encounter while completing this activity, and how did you resolve them?

At first I got confused about where to find system information and how to tell system software apart from application software. I resolved this by following the given steps carefully, exploring my laptop's settings, and checking what each program actually does until I clearly understood the difference.

VII. Scoring Guide

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Criteria	Description	Points
Completeness	All tables (1–4) and required fields are filled out.	30
Accuracy	Recorded specifications and device names match what the tools actually show.	30
Realization / Reflection	Answers are thoughtful, specific to the student's own unit, and well written.	30
Neatness & Timeliness	Worksheet is legible/well-formatted and submitted on time.	10
Total		100

Checked by: Score: / 100

Instructor's Signature over Printed Name / Date

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